



TOOLBOX TALK — WEEKLY SAFETY MEETING

Millwork | Carpentry | Interior Finishes | Material Handling

WEEK 06

Date: Supervisor:

Project / Job Name:

TOPIC: Miter Saw & Chop Saw Safe Operation

OVERVIEW:

The miter saw is one of the most-used tools in finish carpentry, and one of the most frequently involved in hand and finger injuries. The speed and convenience of the miter saw can create a false sense of security — operators begin making cuts quickly and repetitively, and complacency sets in. That

TALKING POINTS — Read to Crew:

1. Every time you make a cut, your hands should be at least 6 inches away from the blade path — on both sides. Many injuries happen on the non-fence side, where the operator's thumb is curled around the workpiece. Use the fence to support the stock, not your fingers. If a piece is too short to hold safely away from the blade, use a clamp or a stop-block system — never shorten the distance
2. The blade on a miter saw does not stop the moment you release the trigger. It continues spinning for several seconds. Never reach into the blade area or lift the head until the blade has come to a complete stop. Do not blow sawdust away from the cut with your hand while the blade is still moving. Develop the habit of waiting and watching until the blade is fully stopped before doing
3. Piece length is a critical safety factor. Never attempt to cut pieces shorter than 12 inches without a dedicated stop-block system. Short pieces have less bearing surface against the fence, are prone to movement during the cut, and put your fingers much closer to the blade than longer stock. If a customer or foreman asks for pieces shorter than 12 inches, cut them from longer stock
4. Before every cut, check that your material is fully against the fence and the table. Material that is not fully supported — round stock, warped boards, twisted pieces — can rotate or rock during the cut and cause the blade to grab. If material will not lie flat, correct the problem before cutting, not after you discover it mid-cut.

DISCUSSION QUESTIONS — Ask Your Crew:

- Q1: What do you do if you need to cut a piece that is too short to hold safely?
Q2: Has anyone seen a miter saw injury? What part of the process went wrong?

KEY SAFETY POINTS:

- Keep fingers at least 6 inches from the blade path at all times
- Secure workpieces — never freehand cut without stock against the fence
- Allow the blade to stop completely before raising the arm
- Never cut pieces shorter than 12 inches without a stop block system
- Wear eye protection — miter saws throw chips aggressively

Crew sign-in sheet on page 2 — all 30 crew members sign on the following page.



CREW SIGN-IN SHEET

WEEK 06

By signing, I confirm I attended this toolbox talk and understand the topic discussed.

#	PRINT NAME	SIGNATURE (click to sign in Acrobat)	#	PRINT NAME	SIGNATURE (click to sign in Acrobat)
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